



THE DECLARATION OF THE TRUE LIVING REPUBLIC OF CONSCIENCE

CLOKEY PRODUCTIONS

When, in the course of human events, institutions cease to serve the people from whom they arise, and instead seek to govern conscience rather than protect it, it becomes the duty of free people to declare the principles by which they shall live. Respect for truth and for our fellow human beings requires that we plainly state the causes which compel such a declaration.

—Article II — The First Principles —

We hold these truths to be discovered through conscience and confirmed by experience: that every human being is created with equal dignity before the Creator; that each person is endowed by the Creator with inherent rights that no earthly power may rightly take away. Among these are life, liberty, conscience, and the freedom to create, to speak truthfully, to associate voluntarily, and to enjoy the fruits of honest labor.

These rights do not proceed from governments, kings, legislatures, or majorities. They arise from the order of creation itself and therefore exist before every human institution.

Communities establish institutions not to grant these rights but to recognize and protect them. Every institution is just only insofar as it remains the servant of conscience rather than its master, and its authority rests solely upon the continuing voluntary consent of those it serves.

Whenever any institution claims authority over conscience, destroys voluntary association, or substitutes coercion for justice, it abandons its rightful purpose and

forfeits its moral legitimacy.

—Article III — Prudence and Peaceful Separation —

Prudence teaches that institutions long established should not be abandoned for light or temporary causes. Experience shows that people are more willing to endure hardship than to dissolve familiar arrangements.

Yet no institution exists for its own sake. Every institution exists to serve living people, and every generation bears the responsibility to examine whether it remains faithful to justice and conscience.

When an institution persistently elevates power above truth, compels what conscience forbids, or forbids what conscience requires, it ceases to deserve voluntary allegiance.

The first duty of free people is not conquest but creation; not destruction but renewal.

Where reform is possible, let reform be pursued. Where peaceful departure is possible, let peaceful departure be chosen. Where new and better institutions can be built, let them be built.

The strongest declaration of liberty is not merely to resist what is wrong, but to create what is right until the old ways are left behind by those who freely choose a better path.

Thus a people guided by conscience do not seek dominion over others. They seek only the freedom to live truthfully, to cooperate voluntarily, and to leave behind every institution that no longer serves justice.

—Article IV — The Signs of Corruption —

We have observed throughout history that institutions lose their legitimacy not in a single moment, but through repeated departures from conscience:

- When they claim authority over truth rather than seek it.
- When they reward obedience above integrity.
- When they replace voluntary cooperation with coercion.
- When they centralize knowledge that belongs among free people.
- When they value power above justice.
- When they make themselves indispensable rather than remaining servants.
- When they teach fear instead of responsibility.

- When they persuade people that dependence is freedom.
- When they silence honest disagreement rather than answer it with reason.
- When they measure success by control instead of human flourishing.
- When they protect themselves before they protect the people they were created to serve.
- When they ask individuals to violate conscience for the sake of convenience, ideology, ambition, or institution.

These are not merely the failures of governments. They are the temptations of every institution, every generation, and every human heart.

Therefore, let every person first examine himself, every family strengthen itself, every community govern itself with justice, and every institution remember that it exists to serve the living rather than to rule them.

The health of a republic is measured not by the strength of its rulers, but by the freedom, responsibility, and conscience of its people.

—Article V — The Right of Peaceful Separation —

Therefore, whenever an institution no longer serves justice, those who remain faithful to conscience possess the natural right to withdraw their voluntary support and to establish new associations founded upon truth, responsibility, and mutual consent.

No person is born to serve an institution. Institutions exist to serve living people.

The freedom to depart is the guardian of every voluntary relationship. Without the right to leave, consent becomes compulsion, and cooperation becomes submission.

Let no one seek domination over another. Let persuasion replace coercion, example replace force, and creation replace conquest.

A free people need not capture every institution that has lost its way. They may instead build better ones, invite others by their example, and allow truth to spread through the voluntary choices of free men and women.

The gate has no fence.

No earthly power can imprison a conscience that refuses to surrender truth, nor can any institution prevent free people from creating what is just, beautiful, and good.

Thus the Living Republic is not founded upon territory or rulers, but upon the shared commitment of people who freely choose to live according to conscience under the

authority of the Creator.

—Article VI — The Covenant of Conscience —

With humble gratitude to the Creator, and with confidence that truth requires no coercion, we therefore affirm these principles as the foundation of the Living Republic.

We pledge ourselves not to the rule of men, but to the rule of conscience under God.

• • •

We shall seek truth before power.

Justice before advantage.

Creation before conquest.

Service before authority.

• • •

We will neither compel another to violate conscience nor surrender our own for comfort, fear, or reward.

We will build where others destroy. We will persuade where others command. We will cooperate where others divide.

We will leave every institution that demands the sacrifice of truth, and we will devote our labor to building those that honor life, liberty, responsibility, and voluntary fellowship.

Knowing that this path may demand sacrifice, misunderstanding, or loss, we nevertheless choose it freely.

For the Kingdom of God is not established by force, but received through faithful hearts.

The Living Republic is not a place.

It is a people.

It is not sustained by power.

It is sustained by conscience.

And to these principles we freely pledge our lives, our work, our honor, and our hope,
trusting not in princes, whose breath returns to the dust, but in the eternal Author of
life, whose truth endures forever.

THE LIVING AGE • CLOKEY PRODUCTIONS